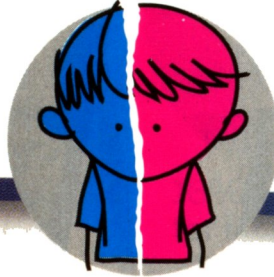


17% find the fights and disagreements at home between family members unbearable

7% are from broken homes



30% watch television for 4 to 6 hours daily



Q: "Does any of your friends indulge in alcohol, cigarettes, drugs, reckless driving and sexual activity?"

Yes: 34%

Q: "Have you ever indulged in alcohol, cigarettes, drugs, reckless driving or sexual activity?" Yes: 32%



Model: DEEPAK KALRA. Courtesy: GLITZ MODELLING/www.indiatodayimages.com

FINISH

“Learn from the past. A 100 years ago, there was no snack food. And low-technology lifestyle demanded physical activity.”

DR K.S. REDDY

DIRECTOR, PHFI



hospitals in Vadodara, feels worried about the lack of awareness among parents. "A 11-year-old weighs 70 kg, yet he is a 'healthy child' to his parents," he says. "Parents also tend to pass on their stress and ambitions to children. More than a child's health, the fact that he would miss a day of school bothers some parents more." Ask Dr Gaur Chaudhary of SGP Institute of Medical Sciences in Lucknow. His project, Hope Initiative, surveyed 22,000 children in 10 districts of Uttar Pradesh. "There's a huge gap between the health of urban and rural children, yet all of them are united in one thing—bad health."

This is one study where there are only losers: parents for their lack of understanding and children for the predicament they find themselves in. The truth, however unsavoury, is writ

large on the wall: regaining the future health of the nation ultimately rests on parents. Cardiologist Dr K.S. Reddy, director of Public Health Foundation of India, recommends looking back and learning from the past. "A 100 years ago, there was no such thing as snack food—nothing you could

pop open and overeat," he says. "People ate plenty of fresh fruits and vegetables. And low-technology lifestyles demanded more physical activity." So find ways to get your child 60 active minutes each day, at least; encourage them to jump around; opt for regular, timely and home-cooked meals. The route to wellbeing is never easy. Parents will need to be healthy role models more than ever if they don't want to be responsible for the dwindling health of generation next. Turn off the television now and go for a walk for your child's sake.

with Nirmala Ravindran in Bangalore; Mitail Patel and Jhilmil Motihar in Mumbai; Adhi Valliappan in Chennai; Arvind Chhabra in Chandigarh; Uday Mahurkar in Ahmedabad; Subhash Mishra in Lucknow; Jhumari Nigam in Vadodara and Ayesha Singh in Delhi